

7.1 Technologies

7.1.1 ADSL

Asymmetric Digital Subscriber Line. This is the technology used to deliver broadband over traditional copper telephone lines. The term Asymmetric denotes the difference between the download and upload speeds of broadband connections. Usually the download speeds are much higher than upload speeds in ADSL. So if you see an advertisement for ADSL at 1 Mbps, most likely that's the download speed. The upload speed maybe 256 or 512 Kbps. In comparison SDSL (Symmetric Digital Subscriber Line) offers equivalent download and upload speeds. Almost always when you read about DSL in the media it normally refers to ADSL.

7.1.2 ATM

Asynchronous Transfer Mode. For most of us, ATM stands for Automatic Teller Machine, the place where you go withdraw money in the middle of the night, but ATM in the networking world is altogether a different kettle of fish! ATMs use 53-byte cells to transmit data which due to its extremely small size and when coupled with appropriate ATM switches results in transmission speeds of 600 Mbps. This kind of transmission speed can be used to send all types of bandwidth hungry applications like videos and high resolution graphics.

7.1.3 Base Station

Originally the towers used by cell phone providers were known as base station. With the advent of wireless LANs and Wi-Fi networks, the meaning of base station has been expanded to include the wireless access points that computers with wireless cards use to communicate. Essentially, a Wi-Fi base station is a router that connects all the computers within its range and also enables the users to connect to the internet.

7.1.4 CAT 5

Category 5. This is an Ethernet cabling standard and one of the most popular these days. To get speeds of 100 Mbps, you need to